Chair's Report



Tim Eddy
Chair

Victorian racing had a great deal to be proud of in FY26, on the track and off it. This report sets out Racing Victoria's (RV) financial and operational performance for the year, together with the wider health of the Victorian Thoroughbred Racing Industry (VTRI), and I present it with real confidence in the direction this industry is travelling.

FY26 marked the point at which our work over the past two years translated into positive financial results. Following a period of substantial structural change and a series of planned deficits in the years after COVID, RV returned to surplus.

That outcome reflects disciplined decisions made over several years, including a sustained program of efficiency measures across the business and the consolidation of our media operations within RV, and it was achieved whilst maintaining returns to industry.

The Board's focus now rests on converting that improved financial position into long-term strength for the industry. RV carries no debt, maintains a sound balance sheet and holds assets that preserve our capacity to invest in the sport's future.

The consolidation of our revised funding model, incorporating an increased allocation of Point of Consumption Tax and a fixed annual contribution from the State Government, continued throughout the period with green shoots appearing for wagering engagement.

The State Government backed Victorian Racing Industry Fund (VRIF) and Major Racing Events Fund (MREF) also continued to fuel vital initiatives from welfare programs to tracks and facility upgrades, raceday entertainment and community engagement.

This Annual Report is published on the cusp of a state election on 28 November 2026 and it is pleasing to have both major parties commit their support for VRIF.

Earlier this year, a new study on the Size and Scope of the Victorian Racing Industry was released and it reaffirmed the importance of the three codes to the state.

In terms of the VTRI, we add $4.1 billion in value to the Victorian economy each year – up from $3.4 billion in 2018-19 – and drive 25,000 full-time equivalent jobs, many in regional Victoria. The study also quantified racing's social contribution with 960 community and charitable organisations supported through racing clubs.

Most significantly, the VTRI is a net contributor to Victoria, generating greater returns to the state than funding received. More specifically, racing generates $569 million in direct taxation in Victoria.

Our role in the community was further demonstrated in January when bushfires affected regional Victoria. Through the Racing for our Regions series, delivered with Country Racing Victoria (CRV) and VRIF, the industry raised more than $200,000 for the CFA & Brigades Donations Fund and the Strathbogie Disaster Relief Fund.

I was immensely proud of the way all within our industry responded during the bushfires and in the recovery phase. As I was when we handed a cheque for $150,000 to the Good Friday Appeal alongside CRV and Southside Racing, thus taking our donations in the last eight years past $750,000.

It's also important to support our own in times of need and we did that with over $900,000 in fuel relief for participants and raceday officials during the peak of the Middle East conflict.

With respect to finances, Aaron addresses that and our FY27 agenda in his CEO's report. My observation is simply that the industry's standing as the national benchmark is neither accidental nor assured. It rests upon the quality of our racing, the standard of our tracks and facilities, and the confidence of the wider community.

On the track, the season produced performances that deserve recognition, including an historic Cox Plate when the curtain fell on the Moonee Valley track as we know it with work now proceeding on its redevelopment.

Subsequent Victorian Racehorse of the Year Half Yours became just the 13th horse to complete the Caulfield Cup and Melbourne Cup double, and Jamie Melham the first woman to ride the winner of both Cups, a decade on from Michelle Payne's breakthrough at Flemington.

Craig Williams claimed a sixth Scobie Breasley Medal, 20 years after his first, together with a 10th Roy Higgins Medal to equal Damien Oliver's tally of metropolitan premierships. My congratulations to them, and to all others recognised at the Victorian Racing Awards.

FY26 was a period of evolution for the RV Board with the appointments of Peita Duncan and Jonathan Hardwick by the Minister for Racing in February.

Peita brings substantial experience in racing administration, governance, integrity and regulatory reform, including 10 years on the Board of Greyhound Racing Victoria, six of them as its Chair. Jonathan is the owner and Chief Executive of HFH Auto Group and brings more than 25 years of experience across law, agribusiness, manufacturing and the automotive sector, along with racehorse ownership.

These appointments followed the departure of Sharon McCrohan in September 2025 after eight years of tremendous service, with Tim Rourke succeeding her as Deputy Chair.

My thanks go to the Minister for Racing, The Hon. Anthony Carbines, for his ongoing support and commitment to the portfolio, along with newly appointed Shadow Minister for Racing, Tim McCurdy, who has a genuine passion for the sport.

I pay tribute to long serving Shadow Minister for Racing, Tim Bull, who announced during the year that he would not seek re-election after 16 years representing East Gippsland. Throughout that period, Tim was a committed advocate for our industry and for the many Victorians who derive their livelihood from it.

The bi-partisan support Victorian racing enjoys in Parliament is one of its great strengths, and it owes much to the contribution of people like Tim, who understood the central role racing plays in many country communities.

To my fellow directors, to Aaron and his Executive Team, and to all of our staff across the RV Group, I offer my sincere thanks for your tireless efforts over the past 12 months.

Our metropolitan and country clubs warrant particular recognition for the standard of racing, hospitality and community connection they delivered throughout the season.

Above all, I thank the owners, trainers, jockeys, stable staff and customers who invest in this sport. Administrative matters occupy plenty of commentary in any given year, but it is the racing itself that holds an audience, and that remains the foundation on which everything else is built.

Yours sincerely,



Tim Eddy
Chair

CEO's Report



Aaron Morrison
Chief Executive Officer

It is with great pleasure that I present the performance of RV for FY25, together with an overview of the key initiatives and activities undertaken to maintain and strengthen Victoria's position as Australia's and one of the world's leading thoroughbred racing jurisdictions.

In my first full year as Chief Executive, our key focus has been on improving promotion of the sport and engagement with a broader audience, striving for greater transparency and collaboration with industry stakeholders, ensuring our business model is lean and efficient, and maximising returns to participants and those who invest in our sport.

Whilst positive progress has been made on all of those fronts, there is still work to be done, and efforts to strengthen outcomes around those key strategic priorities will continue in FY26 and beyond.

In FY25, RV recorded a normalised net deficit for underlying business performance of $2.532 million, which was slightly better than budgeted. This comes after adjustments to exclude one-off accounting and non-business-as-usual activity. Our statutory reported net deficit was $8.885 million, which is an improvement on the $11.834 million reported net deficit in FY24 that came after a run of 11 consecutive surpluses.

Whilst macroeconomic headwinds and the transition of long-term industry funding arrangements were expected to place downward pressure on key revenue streams this year, maintaining strong returns to owners, participants and clubs and continuing to invest in world-class racing and training infrastructure has always remained a clear priority, and we are pleased to have been able to deliver on this.

To support this objective, RV implemented a business-wide efficiency program spanning the 2024 and 2025 reporting periods, which has delivered ongoing savings - a cumulative reduction in operational expenditure of $13.484 million over the two years. Decisions taken in the second half of FY25 are also expected to generate further annualised efficiencies in FY26 and beyond as we right-size our business and work towards returning to break-even whilst continuing to invest in growth.

Whilst the level of engagement in Victorian Thoroughbred Racing (VTR) remained strong, a range of factors led to a small decrease in the amount invested by active customers with wagering turnover declining by 4.0% to $7.611 billion. This total is 8.4% above pre-COVID levels and remains at nation-leading levels amongst Australian racing codes. With the increased PoCT rate coupled with regulatory uncertainty around Federal Government reforms, FY25 saw decreased investment in both customer marketing and promotions, compounding broader macroeconomic pressures impacting the wagering market.

Improving macro conditions and increased investment into our own content-led promotion saw wagering turnover on VTR bounce back in the second half of FY25, partially mitigating the wagering conditions experienced in the first half. I am pleased to report that early wagering figures obtained from the opening quarter of FY26 indicate that trend of consolidation and the positive momentum has continued.

FY25 saw a transition from the historic VicTAB Joint Venture (JV) arrangements to a new multiyear industry distribution model agreed between the State Government and the Victorian Racing Industry (VRI) which provides greater exposure to future growth in the wagering market sector with long-term certainty for racing in Victoria. Noting this substantial transition, combined revenue from wagering and government sources declined marginally by 1.1% to $421.821 million, representing an outperformance relative to our wagering turnover.

We made important and significant changes to the corporate governance structure of our owned media business, Racing.com Media (RDCM), which came under RV operational management from 1 January 2025, to better align these assets with our broader industry growth strategy and to realise important operational efficiencies.

With that strategic restructure now complete, a major focus of our media arm has been to consolidate the future of broadcasting for the sport, and advocate and promote the VTRI to the widest possible audience. I am delighted to report that we have made giant strides in that particular space, securing new long-term broadcast agreements with the Seven Network (free-to-air and digital), Foxtel and Kayo whilst also welcoming Western Australian racing into the RDCM fold, thus growing its audience.

The revamp of the media business continues into FY26 with the planned launch of the enhanced Racing.com website, the digital migration of vital industry publication Inside Racing, and the finalisation of the sale of industry-owned audio broadcast business and radio network, RSN Racing & Sports (RSN) to Sports Entertainment Network (SEN). Further, we also extended a range of major commercial media partnerships to ensure VTR is the most widely distributed racing product that reaches the biggest audiences, positioning the industry for further growth.

The ongoing growth in engagement post the COVID era has also been reflected in attendance figures, with total attendances at Victorian race meetings increasing by almost 5% in FY25 to 1.16 million. This was underlined by excellent crowd growth across all Spring Racing Carnival meetings, with the four days at Flemington over Melbourne Cup Week the highest attended race meetings in Australia in FY25, as attendances across the week grew 9% year-on-year.

It was pleasing to see this upward trend spread beyond metropolitan areas, with total attendance at country meetings up 10% from FY24 to FY25. Turnover was consistent with FY24 across the Country Cup meetings run during the Spring Racing Carnival, defying the broader first half wagering trends and underscoring the importance of country racing.

The introduction of Racing Forums in FY25 contributed markedly to our goal of increasing collaboration with industry stakeholders and clubs. They provided a platform for industry leaders to share ideas and work together methodically on key decisions and initiatives around our racing program.

RV's unwavering commitment to industry and participant support saw expenditure in this area increase by 13.9% to $35.286 million in FY25, with new workforce development programs and initiatives like mental health first aid workshops helping to ensure the highest standards of welfare for our participants and thoroughbreds.

Equine welfare continues to be one of the key pillars of our industry, and RV's $5.94 million investment into equine welfare through expenditure and capital investment across FY25 took our total investment since the 2017 introduction of a contribution from prizemoney to $44 million.

We have been focused on providing greater transparency on how the 2% contribution from prizemoney is being allocated to help improve equine welfare outcomes and maintain our social licence with several industry updates throughout FY25.

On the track, our veterinary protocols continue to set new global safety standards in FY25 as we celebrated the fourth consecutive Spring Racing Carnival without serious injury, whilst our Off The Track program continues to assist in the transition of thoroughbreds to life after racing by creating demand and promoting the unique versatility of the thoroughbred.

Our emergency aid program was the source of a key investment in FY25 with $800,000 in drought relief delivered to support more than 1,800 eligible thoroughbreds in the face of challenging conditions throughout country Victoria.

As we look ahead to FY26, our focus will be on a return to break-even whilst maintaining vital returns and support for participants and owners.
Our restructure and efficiency program throughout FY25 provides the foundation to achieve that objective, whilst we focus on engagement and support from punters for a great racing program.

At this juncture, I would like to extend my deepest gratitude to every industry participant and owner, who, along with our equine athletes, form the lifeblood of our great industry. I'd also like to thank all our metropolitan and country clubs for the pivotal role they play in showcasing our sport and engaging with the community – this is essential for the continued prosperity of the VTRI.

Finally, my thanks also go to the RV Board, led by Chair Tim Eddy, for their continued support and leadership; and to my Executive team and all RV staff members for their incredible contribution to ensuring the success and viability of VTR for the benefit of all.

Yours Sincerely,



Aaron Morrison
Chief Executive Officer

Key Performance Indicators

FY26 (JULY 2025 TO JUNE 2026)

Racing Statistics	Picnic Meetings		Country Meetings		Metro Meetings		Total Meetings		
	FY26	Annual variance (%)	FY26	Annual variance (%)	FY26	Annual variance (%)	FY26	FY25	Annual variance (%)
Number of Meetings Conducted	29	-9.4%	387	-2.3%	106	-5.4%	522	540	-3.3%
Number of Races Conducted	172	-10.9%	3,037	-4.1%	930	-4.5%	4,139	4,333	-4.5%
Number of Horse Starts	1,231	-11.1%	29,836	-4.4%	9,249	-3.6%	40,316	42,188	-4.4%
Number of Individual Horses	355	-3.5%	7,607	-3.9%	3,366	-4.6%	8,752	9,093	-3.8%
Number of Races < 8 Starters	88	-19.3%	473	1.7%	167	-6.7%	728	753	-3.3%
Average Starters per Race	7.2	-0.2%	9.8	-0.4%	9.9	1.0%	9.7	9.7	0.0%

Prizemoney Statistics	Picnic Meetings		Country Meetings		Metro Meetings		Total Meetings		
	FY26	Annual variance (%)	FY26	Annual variance (%)	FY26	Annual variance (%)	FY26	FY25	Annual variance (%)
Prizemoney Paid ($M)	$0.9	-13.0%	$105.1	0.0%	$175.8	0.6%	$281.7	$280.8	0.3%
VOBIS Bonuses Claimed - Silver, Gold, Sires Nominator ($M)	N/A	N/A	$4.7	-6.9%	$3.5	27.1%	$8.2	$7.8	5.0%
Total ($M)	$0.9	-13.0%	$109.8	-0.4%	$179.2	1.0%	$289.9	$288.6	0.5%

Wagering Statistics	Picnic Meetings		Country Meetings		Metro Meetings		Total Meetings		
	FY26	Annual variance (%)	FY26	Annual variance (%)	FY26	Annual variance (%)	FY26	FY25	Annual variance (%)
Parimutuel Turnover ($M)	$0.0	0.0%	$507.7	-8.1%	$639.3	-7.1%	$1,146.9	$1,240.5	-7.5%
Non Parimutuel Turnover ($M)	$2.0	-2.8%	$2,616.4	-4.5%	$3,629.5	0.0%	$6,248.0	$6,370.2	-1.9%
Total Turnover ($M)	$2.0	-2.8%	$3,124.1	-5.1%	$4,268.7	-1.1%	$7,394.9	$7,610.8	-2.8%
Average Turnover per Meeting ($M)	$0.1	7.3%	$8.1	-2.9%	$40.3	4.5%	$14.2	$14.1	0.5%

Participation Statistics	FY26	FY25	Annual variance (%)
Country Attendances (includes Non-TAB/Picnic)	498,242	486,566	2.4%
Metro Attendances	673,508	673,849	-0.1%
Total Attendances	1,171,750	1,160,415	1.0%
Average Individual starts per horse	4.61	4.64	-0.7%
Training stables with a race starter	847	877	-3.4%
Training stables with a race winner	455	473	-3.8%
% of stables with a race starter that trained a winner	53.7%	53.9%	-0.4%
Jockeys with a race ride	289	286	1.0%
Jockeys with a race winner	206	202	2.0%
% of jockeys with a race ride that rode a winner	71.3%	70.6%	0.9%

FY25 Industry Snapshot



$785.1m

2024 SPRING RACING CARNIVAL ECONOMIC BENEFIT TO VICTORIA



$7.39 BN

TOTAL TURNOVER



1.17m

TOTAL ATTENDANCE



2024 MELBOURNE CUP WEEK TOTAL VIEWERS VIA 9NETWORK

4,333

RACES RUN

99.95%

HORSE SAFETY RECORD



64,706

OWNERS



$289.9m

PRIZEMONEY AND BONUSES PAID



$5.94m

EQUINE WELFARE INVESTMENT

$6.62m

REDUCTION IN GROSS OPERATIONAL EXPENDITURE

Racing & Programming



- Headlining a revamped prizemoney model in FY26 was the $5,000 increase to all professional country maidens in Victoria. This unprecedented level of investment represented an additional $7 million in funding for maiden races to boost the initial return that owners receive on their investment.

- Two of the Spring Racing Carnival's flagship races were run for record prizemoney in FY26 with the Lexus Melbourne Cup (3200m) increasing to a record $10 million in recognition of the engagement and financial returns it generates for racing and the economy, both in Victoria and nationally. To celebrate the historic final edition of the Ladbrokes Cox Plate (2040m) at the current Moonee Valley Racecourse prior to its major redevelopment, prizemoney for the 2025 edition of Australia's weight-for-age championship also increased to $6 million.

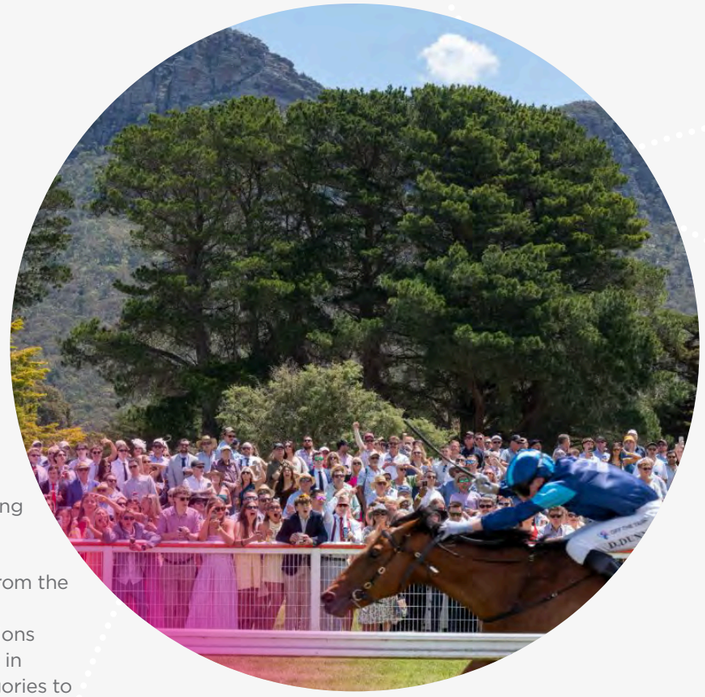
- The Ladbrokes Cox Plate (2040m) was the final race conducted at the famous Moonee Valley Racecourse prior to its major redevelopment and fans flocked to the historic meeting in their droves with attendances up 10% YOY to watch champion mare Via Sistina, her trainer Chris Waller and jockey James McDonald secure back-to-back Cox Plate victories. The trio would complete the Cox Plate-TAB Champions Stakes (2000m) double at Flemington a fortnight later for the second consecutive year.

- The Valley commenced its redevelopment after the Cox Plate meeting which saw four tracks chosen to host 16 transferred meetings on behalf of the Moonee Valley Racing Club (MVRC) – Southside Cranbourne, Southside Pakenham, Ladbrokes Geelong and Caulfield. These meetings were highlighted by the Group 1 William Reid Stakes (1200m) at Caulfield on Saturday, 21 March 2026, where Cindy Alderson and her born again sprinter Jigsaw claimed their maiden Australian Group 1 victory.

- Three Caulfield Group 1 races were repositioned among changes to the program for the 2025 Spring Racing Carnival and 2026 Festival of Racing with the Schweppes Thousand Guineas (1600m) returning from its mid-November timeslot to a place inside the Sportsbet Caulfield Cup Carnival, the Sportsbet Sir Rupert Clarke Stakes (1400m) also returning from mid-November to its previous position in the calendar on Saturday, 20 September 2025, and the Sportsbet C.F. Orr Stakes moving from its traditional February timeslot to maintain Group 1 racing on Saturday, 15 November 2025.

- The decision to shift Flemington's traditional New Year's Day meeting to New Year's Eve proved a major success with turnover increasing by 10% and crowds skyrocketing by 73% to 13,164 including Young Member attendances rising by over 233% as punters engaged prior to their evening celebrations.

- The Ladbrokes Moe Cup (2050m) moved from its traditional Friday timeslot in mid-October to Sunday, 16 November and was won by Cindy Alderson's Howlin' Rain while the Sportsbet Pakenham Cup (2500m) moved one week earlier to Saturday, 13 December 2025 to reduce the gap between the two Southside Slot Series races to three weeks and allow the Club to better engage a pre-Christmas crowd, with attendances increasing by 10%.



- Building on the foundations of a proposal from the Australian Trainers Association (ATA) and Thoroughbred Racehorse Owners Associations (TROA), RV adjusted the ratings categories in Victoria with the creation of four new categories to better serve the population of horses with handicap ratings in the 50s and 60s. These categories aimed to provide lower rated horses, which make up a sizeable portion of the horse population, with more chances to compete against similarly matched opposition. The new categories were introduced from 1 September 2025 and trialled throughout the remainder of the 2025-26 season, offering minimum prizemoney levels from $22,000 to $27,000. The sliding prizemoney scale aimed to create a clear point of difference between categories to foster more competitive racing, whilst rewarding progression up the ratings bands.

- A new scratching fee structure took effect from 1 February 2026 following consultation with all stakeholder groups to protect and enhance field sizes, which have declined over the past decade and continue to be challenged. A new standard scratching fee of $274.25 (ex GST) mirrored the current riding fee that RV is required to pay to the declared rider on a scratched horse. Maximising field sizes through managing the volume of scratchings promotes stronger wagering outcomes which ultimately benefits all through the maintenance of prizemoney and other returns to industry.



- A review into the handicap conditions for the Sportsbet Caulfield Cup and Lexus Melbourne Cup saw the minimum allotted weight for both marquee contests increased from 50kg to 51kg and the minimum topweight raised from 58kg to 59kg. A minimum topweight of 57kg at final acceptance time for both events was also reinstated with the adjustments aiming to provide both races with the best chance of attracting the highest quality field of horses and jockeys, and ensure owners and trainers have a broad cross section of jockeys to choose from. Further consultation saw the implementation of a new weight policy for all professional handicap races run in Victoria from the start of the 2025-26 season.

Victorian Racing Awards

2025-26 Victorian Racing Award Winners

Scobie Breasley Medal – Craig Williams
Victorian Racehorse of the Year – Half Yours
Most Outstanding Training Performance – Tony & Calvin McEvoy (Half Yours)
Tommy Corrigan Medal – Dean Parker
Colin Alderson Rising Star Award – Calvin McEvoy
VJA Damien Oliver Most Valuable Jockey – Jamie Mott
VJA Rising Star – Logan Bates
RV Acknowledged Retrainer of the Year – Yona & Nina Lloyd
RV Acknowledged Retrainer of the Year Runner-Up – Louise Abey

2025-26 Premiership Winners

Metropolitan Trainer – Ciaron Maher (104 wins)
Metropolitan Jockey – Craig Williams (65 wins)
Metropolitan Apprentice – Luke Cartwright (44 wins)
Victorian Trainer – Ciaron Maher (220 wins)
Victorian Jockey – Jamie Mott (128 wins)
Victorian Apprentice – Luke Cartwright (70 wins)
Country Trainer – Ben, Will and JD Hayes (131 wins)
Country Jockey – Will Gordon (109 wins)
Country Apprentice – Bailey Kinninmont (33 wins)
Picnic Trainer – Troy Kilgower (30 wins)
Picnic Jockey – Shaun Cooper (40 wins)
Jumps Trainer – Symon Wilde (11 wins)
Jumps Jockey – Dean Parker (11 wins)








1. Tony & Calvin McEvoy
2. Logan Bates
3. Yona & Nina Lloyd
4. Dean Parker
5. Luke Cartwright
6. Jamie Mott

2025-26 Feature Race Winners














1. Half Yours cemented his place in history as the 13th horse to complete the Caulfield-Melbourne Cup double
2. An incredible fourth Cox Plate in a row for James McDonald as he and Via Sistina went back-to-back
3. Jamie Melham became the first female jockey to win the Caulfield Cup aboard Half Yours
4. Streisand was on song to deliver Clinton McDonald a second Blue Diamond in three years
5. Ceolwulf (right) faired best in the howling rain to win a thrilling Champions Mile
6. Tom Kitten again got his head in front where it matters most to win back-to-back All-Star Miles
7. Tentyris produced a devastating turn of foot in the Coolmore to secure his place on Darley's stallion roster
8. Farag defied top weight to etch his name into Jericho Cup folklore
9. Celine Guadray secured her first ever Melbourne Cup ride after Torranzino landed the rescheduled Geelong Cup
10. Jigsaw put it all together to win the second edition of The Meteorite
11. Big Wigs carried some famous silks to victory in the $1m Showdown
12. Instigator (left) proved age is just a number with a perfect Grand Annual swansong

Owners & Breeders

In FY26, a total of 61,762 people experienced the thrill of owning a racehorse in Victoria, which represents a slight decrease on the FY25 figure of 64,706. Notwithstanding the fractional decline, Victoria still boasts more registered owners, part-owners and owners aged 25 or younger than any other racing jurisdiction in Australia, while registered syndicate members are almost double that of the next placed state.

Owners Digital Ticketing Platform

Racing Victoria (RV), with the valued support of the Victorian Government, launched a new dedicated owners digital ticketing platform in FY26 to modernise and enhance the raceday experience for racehorse owners.

The project was delivered in partnership with the Thoroughbred Racehorse Owners Association (TROA) and with the support of Country Racing Victoria (CRV) and Victoria's race clubs, realised through a significant investment from the Victorian Government's Victorian Racing Industry Fund (VRIF) with a focus on supporting owners and encouraging participation in the sport.

Phase 1

From September 2025, Phase 1 of the project allowed owners to access the platform to obtain a digital copy of their Victorian Owner Gold Card for immediate use.

This ensured that owners permanently had their pass with them on their phone, providing seamless and efficient racecourse entry prior to collecting any additional raceday ticketing ahead of Phase 2.

Phase 2

A successful trial of Phase 2 saw the integration of raceday ticketing at select race meetings throughout July 2026, allowing owners to log in to access and share their digital admission, members' reserve and mounting yard tickets, plus hospitality entitlements.

The full integration of raceday ticketing was launched at the start of the 2026-27 season and made available for all Victorian race meetings.

Victorian Owners and Breeders Incentive Scheme (VOBIS)

In FY26, $15.5 million in VOBIS prizemoney, bonuses and vouchers was distributed to participants, making VOBIS the richest incentive program in Australian racing.

Open exclusively to VOBIS Gold and VOBIS Platinum horses, the Premier Race Series offered $5.6 million in prizemoney, bonuses and vouchers across 17 premium races.

Offering in excess of $7.5 million in vouchers each season, the VOBIS Platinum program continues to support owners, breeders, trainers and syndicators by incentivising reinvestment in the Victorian industry. Since its inception, more than $9 million in VOBIS Platinum vouchers has been won.

In FY26, 70 stallions were nominated to the VOBIS Sires program, ensuring their progeny are eligible for the lucrative VOBIS Platinum bonuses and vouchers.

The results of a comprehensive review of the VOBIS program, comprising customer research, stakeholder submissions and analysis of racing and VOBIS data, were analysed in FY26 with enhancements implemented for the start of the 2026-27 season to provide greater consistency and clarity across the program.

2026 Victorian Breeding Awards

- Racing Victoria VOBIS Nominator of the Year - Godolphin
- Racing Victoria VOBIS Sire of the Year - Blue Point
- Racing Victoria VOBIS Trainer of the Year - Ben, Will & JD Hayes
- Racing Victoria VOBIS Horse of the Year - Flying Done



Infrastructure & Projects

FY26 saw RV and CRV strengthen our investment in regional racing through the creation of a dedicated Country Tracks and Facilities Coordinator, a role created to provide greater support to country clubs in the preparation and maintenance of racetracks across Victoria.

Complementing this initiative, RV added three Regional Track Managers to increase our network to 10, further enhancing raceday track management, inspections and support throughout the state.

Thanks to strong support from the State Government's VRIF and contributions from clubs, and/or CRV and RV, several improvements to racing infrastructure were either completed or started across the state in FY26. These include:

- The redevelopment of the The Valley commenced in October 2025, rendering the track offline until the targeted return date of Spring 2027. The new racecourse complex will feature a reconfigured track with a new surface and an extended home straight, as well as new horse areas and new facilities for both racing administration and customers.
- The Benalla course proper underwent a full reconstruction with the installation of a sandy loam track and an upgraded drainage system. Key improvements also included the reinstatement of the 2,300-metre chute to provide greater flexibility in race starts and distances, as well as the widening of the track from 16 metres to 19 metres.
- Following the 2025 Bendigo Cup meeting, the Bendigo course proper was fully resurfaced on a kikuyu turf base to improve turf health, racing condition and drainage. The track has since returned to racing and is regarded as one of the premier surfaces in Victoria.
- The Ballarat Synthetic track underwent a full resurface in FY26 and has since returned to racing after being given an extended period of consolidation.
- To allow for better drainage and movement of horses, the tie-up stall precinct was reworked at Sale, while a new bank of stalls was built at Warracknabeal.
- Irrigation installations and upgrades have been carried out at over 30 racecourses in recent years, with Swan Hill and Stony Creek two of the most recent recipients.
- The continuation of other programs of upgrades included jockey rooms, judges and stewards' towers, barrier stalls, vet areas, ambulance tracks and plastic running trails.

These upgrades have helped contribute to a 50% reduction in transferred and abandoned meetings over a 12-month period, despite an abnormally high volume of heavy tracks encountered during the 2026 calendar year.

RV's Rider Development Centre was also unveiled at the end of FY26. The state-of-the-art facility features a dedicated mechanical horse room, fully equipped gym, physiotherapy and treatment rooms, and training areas that will enhance coaching and skill development for riders across all stages of their development, from trackwork riders through to senior jockeys.

Beyond its rider development functions, the facility will also serve as a hub for industry education and collaboration, boasting a versatile space that can host stakeholder events and strengthen connections across the Victorian racing industry.

Infrastructure improvements, both major and minor, will continue throughout FY27, spearheaded by the resurfacing of the Caulfield course proper, which commenced following the Caulfield Cup meeting in October of this year.

Pakenham lights

Workforce Development

Stable Start™

Stable Start™, RV's entry-level education program for people seeking a career in the VTRI, continued to provide an important introduction to stable employment and industry training opportunities.

In FY26, 45 participants completed the program, which provides practical experience in horse handling, welfare and workplace safety. Delivered in partnership with the Racing Education Centre, Stable Start™ remains an accessible pathway for individuals looking to commence a career in racing, while also supporting existing stable employees to formalise their qualifications and progress to further training opportunities.

In addition to Stable Start, 104 enrolments were recorded across Certificate III Trackwork Rider qualifications, riding skill sets and mandatory stablehand units during FY26. These training opportunities help develop a skilled workforce while ensuring participants have access to clear pathways for career progression within the industry.

Trackwork Rider Program

RV's Trackwork Rider Program continued to offer aspiring riders structured, practical training within a racetrack environment.

Delivered at Cranbourne and Pakenham, the program provided 16 participants with access to specialist coaching and skill development, supporting the safe acquisition of trackwork riding competencies. The initiative remains a key component of RV's participant development pathway, helping riders build the experience required to pursue long-term careers in racing stables and related industry roles.

Rider Development Squad

The Rider Development Squad (RDS) continued to play a vital role in developing the next generation of trackwork riders and potential apprentice jockeys, with 77 riders participating in the program during FY26.

Educational sessions covered nutrition, sports psychology, goal setting, form analysis, race replay reviews, race tactics and communication, while mechanical horse training and strength and conditioning programs provided opportunities to further enhance riding skills and personal wellbeing.

Current and former jockeys including Jaylah Kennedy, Steven King, Tiani Chapman and Jett Stanley also contributed to the program, assisting with mechanical horse sessions and sharing valuable industry knowledge and experience with participants.

School Tours

RV continued to engage secondary school students through its school tour program, providing structured, behind-the-scenes experiences that showcase the breadth of career opportunities available within the thoroughbred racing industry.

Targeted primarily at students undertaking equine studies programs, the tours were conducted across racecourses and training centres throughout Victoria and highlighted the diverse range of industry roles available beyond riding, including veterinary services, stewarding, media, administration and stable operations. The program also plays an important role in challenging perceptions of the industry and educating students on the high standards of equine welfare that underpin Victorian racing.

During FY26, 160 students participated in tours across metropolitan and regional Victoria, including students from Box Hill Institute, Box Hill Institute Bellarine, Hillcrest College, GOTAFE and local learning and employment networks. With participants typically approaching working age, the initiative continues to serve as an important introduction to potential careers within racing and a pathway into RV's workforce development programs.

Schools-Based Stablehand Training

RV's partnership with education providers continued to create pathways for young people to gain the skills and qualifications required to enter the racing industry.

During FY26, 80 students completed stablehand training with 60 Box Hill Institute students undertaking a program at Pakenham and a further 20 Box Hill Institute Bellarine students completing training at Geelong.

The training incorporated practical horse handling and workplace-based learning experiences, helping students develop the knowledge, confidence and capabilities required for future employment within the VTRI.

Pony Club Victoria Ride to Time Partnership

RV's partnership with Pony Club Victoria (PCV) continued to strengthen grassroots engagement with young riders across the state through the Ride to Time program.

Throughout FY26, RV visited 15 Pony Club and attended every zone qualifying event held across PCV's ten zones, with Workforce Development Program Coach and professional jockey Tayla Childs playing a key role in the program's delivery. Designed to develop pace awareness, control, judgement and riding safety, Ride to Time provides participants with practical riding experiences while introducing them and their families to the many career opportunities available within the racing industry.

The 2025 Ride to Time State Championships were held at The Valley on Moir Stakes night with 20 finalists from across Victoria qualifying through regional events to compete in the Maiden and Open divisions. Riders were challenged to complete a 1000-metre course as close as possible to a predetermined benchmark time, demonstrating horsemanship, rhythm and pace judgement.

The championships were followed by RV's first ever Pony Club Rider Development Day, where 20 riders participated in mechanical horse coaching, strength and conditioning sessions delivered by the Victorian Institute of Sport, and educational workshops focused on the role of Stewards, participant protection and wellbeing, and equine welfare. Eight parents and guardians also attended the day, which was held in RV's new state-of-the-art Rider Development Centre at RV headquarters in Flemington.

With more than 30 Ride to Time sessions delivered annually across Victoria, the program continues to provide a strong connection between the equestrian and racing communities while supporting RV's broader workforce development objectives.



Apprentice Jockey Training Program

The Apprentice Jockey Training Program (AJTP) remained the cornerstone of RV's jockey development pathway during FY26, providing aspiring riders with the education, mentoring and practical support required to build successful riding careers.

As at 30 June 2026, 38 apprentice jockeys were enrolled in the four-year program, and nine riders had completed the formal training component of the program and continued to ride as claiming apprentices while transitioning towards full senior rider status.

Victoria also rejoined the National Apprentice Racing Series (NARS) in FY26, which was held across the six participating jurisdictions. A sextet of Victorian apprentice jockeys represented the state throughout the series, competing against their interstate peers and furthering their development through exposure to a variety of racing environments and conditions.

At the 2026 Apprentice Graduation and Awards Night, the following achievements were recognised:

- Victorian Jockeys Association Outstanding Apprentice Jockey in Training – Emily Pozman
- RV Elite Apprentice Jockey Award – Jaylah Kennedy
- Andrew Gilbert Sports Science Award – Nadia Daniels
- Mikaela Claridge Sportsmanship Award – Thomas Prebble
- Wakeful Club Scholarship – Stephanie Hateley
- RV Coaches Award (new for 2026) – Sam Kennedy

The awards ceremony also saw nine new members formally welcomed into Victoria's Apprentice Jockey Squad (AJS), which serves as a pre-apprenticeship program and focuses on riders who have demonstrated the potential to progress to race riding within the next 12 months. Seven of those have since progressed into the AJPT.

Integrity Services

RV's Integrity Services Department plays a central role in protecting the integrity, reputation and sustainability of the VTRI.

Equine Sample Collection

A total of 11,884 equine samples were collected during the 2025-26 racing season, with prohibited substances detected in 15 samples (0.12%).

A total of 1,150 equine samples were collected as part of RV's out-of-competition testing program.

Safety Record

Victoria's raceday fatality rate for flat racing remains among the lowest in the world of thoroughbred racing, and investment in equine welfare initiatives such as advanced diagnostic imaging continues to help reduce that rate further towards 0.00%.

In the 2025-26 racing season, there were 22 fatalities in flat racing in Victoria from 40,355 starts. This is equivalent to a fatality rate of 0.05%.

Additionally, RV's Jumps Taskforce welcomed the continued improvement in the safety record of Jumps Racing since the 16 safety and operational measures were adopted following an extensive review in 2024, which recommended a number of key changes to the program.

In the 2026 jumps racing season, which ran from late March until the middle of August, there were three fatalities in jumps races in Victoria from 371 starters. That is the same number as the 2025 season and is equivalent to a fatality rate of 0.8%, which remains down from the 1.2% recorded in 2024 prior to the review.

Spring Racing Carnival Veterinary Protocols

RV continued to refine its world-leading Spring Racing Carnival veterinary protocols in FY25 and last spring delivered a fifth successive Melbourne Cup Carnival without serious injury to a competing horse. The protocols remain underpinned by comprehensive veterinary assessments and advanced imaging requirements for international horses and Melbourne Cup contenders, reflecting RV's ongoing commitment to minimising injury risk and safeguarding horse welfare.

Enhancements for 2025 included a more streamlined CT scanning regime for international horses not nominated to compete in the Caulfield Cup, Cox Plate or Melbourne Cup, while all Melbourne Cup runners were required to undergo their final pre-race veterinary inspection in Victoria on the eve of the race, ensuring a consistent and comprehensive assessment process for every acceptor.

In a further strengthening of the protocols, RV also introduced access to Positron Emission Tomography (PET) scanning to provide additional diagnostic information where mandatory CT scans identify a potential concern, assisting veterinarians in making more informed decisions on a horse's suitability to compete.





Mandatory Respectful Workplace Training

RV continued its commitment to fostering safe, inclusive and respectful workplaces throughout the VTRI with the rollout of the mandatory Leaders Racing for Respectful Workplaces training program.

Developed with the support of the Australian Trainers' Association and informed by a series of successful pilot workshops, the program was designed to equip trainers, assistant trainers and forepersons with practical tools to promote positive workplace cultures and better manage workplace issues when they arise. The training addressed key topics including psychosocial hazards, bullying, harassment and the creation of psychologically safe working environments, using an interactive workshop format and racing-specific scenarios to ensure the content was relevant and practical for participants.

More than 1,000 participants completed the training through 19 in person workshops conducted across metropolitan and regional Victoria. Completion of the workshop became a requirement for licence and registration renewal for the 2026-27 racing season, ensuring workplace leadership standards remain aligned with contemporary community expectations and employment obligations.

The program formed part of RV's broader Respect at Work initiative and built upon previous mandatory workplace safety and behaviour training.

Formestane

In response to emerging scientific questions relating to formestane and a number of associated compounds, Racing Victoria commissioned the Racing Analytical Services Limited (RASL) to undertake a comprehensive international research study examining more than 15 target substances, including formestane and dehydroepiandrosterone (DHEA), in May 2026. The study has been initiated to further the industry's understanding of whether these substances, or their metabolites, may occur naturally within horses and, if so, at what concentration levels.

This represents one of the most significant studies of its kind undertaken by the Australian racing industry. Work is already underway and will involve Australian and international racing laboratories analysing a minimum of 1,000 equine urine samples over an anticipated 12 to 18-month period.

Importantly, the study will involve multiple independent laboratories, with the findings to be subject to peer review and publicly released upon completion. The research is intended to provide a stronger scientific foundation for future regulatory decision-making both in Australia and internationally.

Should the study determine that formestane and its metabolites occur naturally at low levels in racehorses, the findings may assist in informing future consideration of threshold-based regulation, consistent with the approach currently applied to other endogenous substances under the Australian Rules of Racing. Until that time, formestane remains a prohibited substance under the Rules of Racing.

Equine Welfare

Equine welfare remains central to the long-term sustainability of the VTRI, with RV continuing to invest in programs and initiatives that reduce injury risk, create demand for thoroughbreds beyond racing and provide a safety net when hardship arises, ensuring that thoroughbreds are supported at every stage of their lives.

RV invested $5.55 million in equine welfare in FY26, taking our total investment in equine welfare since the introduction of a prizemoney contribution in 2017 to over $50 million. This supported thousands of thoroughbreds across Victoria through a range of initiatives in FY26, including:

Category	FY25 Spend (%)	FY24 Spend (%)
Post Racing, Safety Net & Visibility	46.3%	37.6%
Risk Reduced Racing (Injury Prevention)	18.1%	32.2%
Equine Welfare & Veterinary Operations	30.0%	28.6%
Industry Education & Reputation	5.6%	1.6%

Bushfire Support and Emergency Aid

In January 2026, RV provided close to $150,000 in assistance from its Equine Welfare Fund to support more than 600 thoroughbreds impacted by bushfires across regional Victoria. The funding supported a range of immediate welfare needs including transport, relocation, feed and temporary stabling.

Beyond financial assistance, RV's Equine Welfare team played a key coordination role, working alongside industry participants, race clubs, government agencies and emergency refuge locations to facilitate the safe relocation and ongoing care of horses affected by the fires. This response highlighted the strength of the industry's welfare network and helped ensure thoroughbreds in impacted areas continued to receive appropriate care and support during a challenging period for regional communities.

In addition to emergency support measures, RV's Vulnerable Thoroughbred Programs provided assistance to 48 retired racehorses across the Companion Program, Emergency Aid Program and Short Term Assisted Recovery (STAR) Program. These initiatives continue to provide an important safety net for vulnerable thoroughbreds requiring short-term support, rehabilitation or intervention.

Transition Support Programs

During FY26, more than 400 Off The Track (OTT) thoroughbreds received support through RV's suite of transition programs.

Building on the initial success of the one-off husbandry support subsidy for horses entering the Acknowledged Retrainer Program, which was accessed by over 200 thoroughbreds in FY26, RV introduced a Retrainer Competition Subsidy in August to help encourage newly retrained thoroughbreds to gain competitive exposure in their new equestrian pursuit. The initiative provides Acknowledged Retrainers with a one-off $250 rebate on eligible competition entry fees, further incentivising the use of retired racehorses in equestrian disciplines.

To further assist with rehoming outcomes, RV's globally acclaimed Off The Track Community (OTTC) platform launched a new 'OTT Available' feature, enabling prospective owners to more easily identify horses that have completed retraining and are ready to embark on their next chapter.

The OTTC celebrated its fifth birthday during FY26 and remains one of the most comprehensive post-racing visibility systems in the world. From its launch in 2021 to the end of FY26, more than 12,800 location updates have been provided through the platform, including almost 8,000 with confirmed ownership details and over 4,000 with an emergency contact through the Full Circle program.

Off The Track Program

RV's OTT Program continued to experience strong growth throughout FY26, driven by increasing participation across competitions, education clinics and community initiatives designed to showcase the versatility of retired racehorses.

The inaugural Off The Track Carnival at Boneo Park - Victoria's largest and richest equestrian event dedicated to thoroughbreds - was an unequivocal success, attracting over 380 entries across four disciplines and 17 championship classes. Entries for the second edition, held in September, reached capacity within hours and saw 500 thoroughbreds compete across an expanded three-day carnival. The overwhelming response highlighted the growing popularity of retired racehorses and further strengthened the relationship between the racing and equestrian communities.

Participation in Off The Track-sponsored events reached record levels during FY26, with 6,157 thoroughbred entries recorded across the state, an increase of 16% year-on-year. Demand for RV's subsidised education clinics also increased, with 683 subsidies redeemed across the 94 clinics conducted throughout Victoria in FY26, almost double the amount from the previous year. These clinics provide valuable development opportunities for horses and riders alike, helping to build capable and confident OTT owners.

Community Engagement

In addition to maintaining a presence at major industry events such as the Inglis Premier Yearling Sale, Melbourne International 3 Day Event and Royal Melbourne Show, RV's equine welfare team hosted an activation in Flemington's Park Precinct during the 2025 Melbourne Cup Carnival (MCC) in partnership with Living Legends, Riding For The Disabled Victoria and Equine Pathways Australia.

With over 286,000 attending the MCC last year, activations like this introduce new audiences to the thoroughbred, showcase the care and support provided throughout a thoroughbred's life, and strengthen public trust and understanding of the industry's commitment to welfare.

RV also proudly supported the inaugural National Thoroughbred Week (NTW) in November 2025. In only its first year, over 1,000 people attended NTW activities hosted at RV Acknowledged Retrainer properties throughout Victoria, demonstrating strong community interest in retired racehorses and the plethora of post-racing pathways available to them.

Following the success of the inaugural event, RV looks forward to supporting the second edition of



National Thoroughbred Week in 2026 and continuing to promote the suitability of thoroughbreds for a wide range of post-racing careers.

Welfare Checks

Members of the Compliance Assurance Team (CAT) conducted inspections involving 995 active and retired thoroughbreds across Victoria in FY26 to ensure appropriate welfare standards were being maintained. That figure is in addition to the 2,426 stable inspections undertaken by RV's Integrity Services Department, which continue to provide regular oversight of active thoroughbreds in training.

The Equine Welfare team also undertook proactive visits to RV's network of over 50 Acknowledged Post-Racing Program Providers who care for hundreds of retired racehorses across the state, helping ensure high welfare standards are maintained across all stages of the thoroughbred life cycle.

Onsite Humane Euthanasia Program

During FY26, 199 thoroughbreds were humanely euthanised under RV's Onsite Humane Euthanasia Program (OHEP), ensuring eligible horses that satisfied the strict governing criteria received an appropriate end-of-life outcome when they had negligible prospects of recovery from a chronic injury or illness, or rehoming was no longer possible.

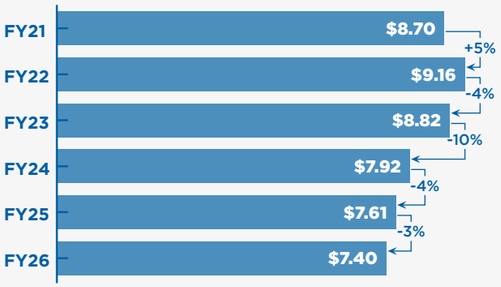
Wagering

Wagering turnover on Victorian Thoroughbred Racing (VTR) fell (-2.8%) year-on-year (YoY), driven partially by a reduced racing program, with approximately 160 fewer races conducted across the year due to programming changes and abandonments.

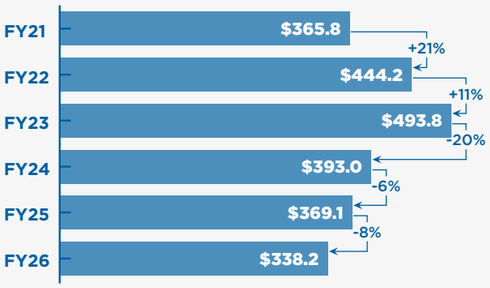
Challenging macroeconomic conditions and ongoing uncertainty surrounding the Federal Government's regulatory reforms weighed on VTR turnover, materialising in lower Wagering Service Provider (WSP) customer generosity spend (FBT -8.4%) and restrained marketing. Wagering on sport continues to grow in popularity among customers, reducing racing's share of overall customer wallet while also expanding the addressable market.

On an underlying basis, average turnover per race increased by 0.7%, indicating that the Victorian Thoroughbred Racing product remained resilient despite ongoing macroeconomic, regulatory and

TURNOVER ($BILLIONS)



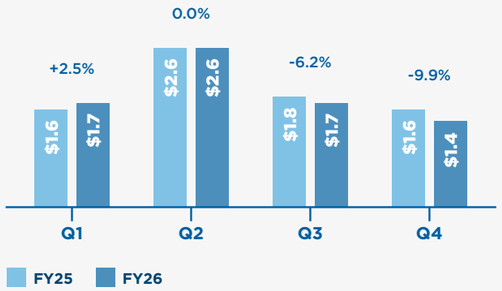
FREE BET TURNOVER ($MILLIONS)



TURNOVER TRENDS

Turnover was stable in the first half of the year (+1.0%), before deteriorating in the second half of the year (-7.9%).

TURNOVER ($BILLIONS)
By Quarter (YoY%)



H1

H1 FY26 delivered a comparatively resilient wagering result, with turnover increasing by 1.0% YoY to approximately $4.3 billion.

The Spring Racing Carnival once again demonstrated its popularity, with 19 of the top 20 turnover races run in Victoria between Turnbull Stakes Day (October 4) and Champions Day (8 November).

Across all meetings during the Spring Carnival period, total domestic turnover grew to $2.84 billion representing a +3.2% YoY increase, underscored by a successful Melbourne Cup Carnival at Flemington (+8.9% YoY). Turnover on the Melbourne Cup reached a record $247m, more than four times higher than any other race in the nation.

Caulfield Cup Carnival wagering improved +3.9% vs. 2024, highlighted by a +7.7% increase in Caulfield Cup Day turnover, which benefitted from the addition of the Thousand Guineas to the program. Turnover for the revamped Orr Stakes meeting at Caulfield was comparable to 2024, despite featuring one less G1 race (Thousand Guineas and Sir Rupert Clarke Stakes on the 2024 program).

TOP 5 TURNOVER RACES IN FY26	
1	Lexus Melbourne Cup
2	Caulfield Cup
3	Cox Plate
4	Victoria Derby
5	Coolmore Stud Stakes

Cox Plate Carnival turnover was just below 2024 (-2.4%), impacted by softer field sizes for the Cox Plate meeting. The Cox Plate itself performed well given the small field (8 starters), and sits comfortably as the third biggest wagering race for the year in Victoria:

H2

Wagering conditions became more challenging during H2 FY26, with turnover declining (-7.9%) year-on-year to approximately $3.1 billion. The weaker result reflected a combination of fewer races, wet tracks, unfavourable customer results, the transfer of meetings away from The Valley during its renovation and broader macroeconomic headwinds.

Turnover on the Festival of Racing was marginally down year-on-year (-1.2%), however the prior year was artificially inflated by abandoned racing at Rosehill and Doomben on Australia Cup Day. Excluding Australia Cup Day, turnover on the Festival of Racing was up +3.5% YoY.

Bendigo Golden Mile Day was shifted to early May in 2026, replaced in early April by the Anniversary Vase meeting at Caulfield to ensure metropolitan racing was run alongside Day 2 of The Championships at Randwick. Turnover across the two meetings was up +9.1% YoY.

Twilight racing was popular with customers, delivering turnover of +17.5% on comparable day meetings in the second half of the year, supporting the view that wagering improves when the audience is more likely to engage with VTR.

INCOME TRENDS

Race fields income increased to approximately $228.8 million, up 2.2% on the prior year, despite the decline in total turnover and similar WSP margins. This outcome was supported by the full-year impact of race fields model changes introduced in FY25 and the continued shift of wagering activity toward digital and fixed-odds channels, which remain the key drivers of product fee income.

Point of Consumption Tax distributions increased to approximately $129.8 million, due to one-off auditing by the Department of Treasury and Finance. State Government funding provided an additional source of long-term funding certainty under the new industry distribution arrangements.



Media



FY26 was about future-proofing Racing Victoria's (RV) media business. Long-term agreements secured distribution, rights and revenue to the end of the decade, while a new content and broadcast strategy rebuilt how Victorian racing reaches audiences and promotes itself.

A softer wagering advertising market saw media revenue ease to $83.1 million (-2.7% year-on-year). Media services expenditure fell $6.1 million to $54.4 million, largely reflecting lower supply and distribution costs under new supply chain arrangements. This delivered an operating surplus (before club media rights payments, depreciation and amortisation) of $28.7 million (+15.4% year-on-year). Media rights payments to race clubs were $33.0 million, up $2.2 million on FY25.

Content & Broadcast

RV's Content & Broadcast division, including Racing.com, exists to deliver Australia's best live racing coverage and showcase Victorian racing to as many people as possible.

Racing.com reached an average of 867,000 unique

Melbourne Cup Carnival audience grew 7.5 per cent.

Beyond broadcast, the new Media & Content Strategy (Grow Racing. Build Audiences. Make People Care.) positioned Racing.com as the content engine for Victorian racing, with one team producing for broadcast, web, RV's 17 owned social accounts and the Spring Racing Carnival channels. These delivered more than 400 million impressions, 108 million video views and 190,000 new followers. YouTube became a key channel with 3.2 million views, and The Verdict podcast passed 15,000 downloads in its first 10 episodes.

Racing.com also made equine welfare and life after racing a regular part of its coverage, with 40 dedicated stories. Off The Track Carnival coverage at Boneo Park drew more than 274,000 video views, and the Melbourne International Three Day Event campaign delivered more than 977,000 views with no paid promotion.

Key Media Partnerships

New and extended agreements signed in FY26 secure the long-term future of Racing.com and the wider media operation.

- Sky - domestic and international: A new agreement with Sky Racing (Sky) took effect on 1 March 2026. It extends domestic arrangements and, for the first time, brings RV's international distribution into the partnership with Sky and Tabcorp, moving North American, UK, Irish and European distribution from Sports Information Services (SIS) to Sky. It sits within a broader long-term commercial partnership between RV and Tabcorp.

- Melbourne Cup Carnival on Racing.com: Racing.com secured Melbourne Cup Carnival broadcast rights from 2025 to 2029 through a sub-licence agreement finalised on the eve of the 2025 Carnival. Despite the short lead time, it attracted a four-day carnival sponsorship, and Kia increased its investment across the week.

renewed to 31 July 2030, with Racing.com Media holding exclusive rights to all RSA media content from 1 August 2026. A new commercial structure removes fixed cost while keeping South Australian racing alongside Victorian racing.

- New racing on Racing.com: Racing.com added Tasmanian racing through a showcase agreement covering 10 free-to-air meetings a year, including Tasmania's key cup days and a Ladbrokes Live Under Lights night series.

- A new UK agreement through Sky and IMG covers 42 feature meetings, starting with the Cheltenham Festival on 10 March 2026.

- World Pool and international distribution: World Pool is a Hong Kong Jockey Club (HKJC) initiative that brings the world's best races, particularly Group 1s, into commingled pari-mutuel pools. Bigger pools attract punters worldwide, deliver significant returns to host clubs and help build a genuine international circuit of premium racing.

- In a strong endorsement from the HKJC, 109 Victorian races across feature Spring and Autumn racedays in Melbourne will be part of World Pool in 2026-27, up from 30 in 2025-26 and more than any other Australian jurisdiction.

- The increase reflects the quality of Victorian racing and RV's close relationship with the HKJC, which also includes Hong Kong racing coverage on Racing.com and a staff exchange program that has run successfully for two years. During FY26, RV also took back its World Pool rights from SIS under a new HKJC agreement and now manages them in-house, working more closely with Tabcorp.

- New Zealand distribution, which RV manages directly, was extended to 2030. Revenue from these international arrangements flows to clubs after limited cost recovery by RV.

Sale of RSN to SEN



on 1 September 2025. A new six-year radio partnership with SEN guarantees coverage of Victorian racing, and daily live coverage continued uninterrupted through the handover. RV thanks the RSN team for their long contribution to Victorian racing.

Outside Broadcast: Satellite to LiveU

At tracks without a Digital Video Network (DVN) connection, TRP moved outside broadcasts from satellite trucks to cellular and Starlink delivery via LiveU. After trials in July 2025 and a first standalone broadcast at Donald on 2 December 2025, 37 of the season's 38 remaining non-DVN meetings switched to LiveU from February 2026. This cuts per-meeting costs by more than 80 per cent, saving around $500,000 a year once fully in place.

Industry Promotion

This Is How We Spring returned for a second year, lifting unprompted recall from 41 to 54 per cent, with TV and social the strongest drivers.

RV worked closely with clubs to win the home market. Isentia analysis of coverage from 28 September to 25 October 2025 shows Victorian races held 65 per cent share of voice in Victoria, with three of four key Victorian races outperforming their NSW equivalents and a cumulative audience of more than 70 million.

RV also hosted British content creator Stephen Power (Racing Blogger) to take the Spring Carnival to an international audience. His content resonated most strongly at home, drawing more than 44 million social views.

Industry Support

RV thanks participants, clubs, and wagering, commercial and media partners for supporting Racing.com and the wider media business through FY26. Their willingness to help tell racing's stories is what lets the sport reach new audiences.

Industry & Community Support



INDUSTRY & COMMUNITY SUPPORT

Participant Welfare and Wellbeing

Significant investment in participant welfare continued during FY26, delivering programs and initiatives that support jockeys, trainers and stable staff.

Close to $2.7 million was invested in jockey welfare initiatives, including fully funded public liability and personal accident insurance, specialist medical and wellbeing support and the Jockey Assistance Program which includes 24/7 sports psychology. This funding also underpins the Emergency Relief Fund which supports current and retired riders, career transition and education assistance, and equipment replacement assistance following racing incidents.

Since the introduction of the trainer and stable staff welfare contribution in February 2024, more than $5.2 million has been invested in industry support programs. A key initiative is the WorkCover Support Service, delivered with the Australian Trainers' Association, providing safety, risk management and injury claims support to more than 120 major stables. The service has reduced average return-to-work times for injured staff by 55%, with longer-term benefits expected to help stabilise WorkCover premiums over the next two to three years.

Dedicated wellbeing and participant protection resources were strengthened, alongside Stableline, the industry's free and confidential 24/7 counselling service. Education and workplace culture initiatives included Wellbeing Musters, Mental Health First Aid training and Leaders Racing for Respectful Workplaces workshops.

Additional support was provided through the HR Assist Service, offering employment advice and workplace guidance, and the Thurgood Duckling Fund which delivered emergency relief to participants experiencing hardship.

Throughout FY26, RV also completed or absorbed into practice the key recommendations from the Racing Integrity Commissioner's review of VRI victim support and complaint processes. This included the Victorian Thoroughbred Racing Restorative Engagement Program which was delivered by Alfi Health and for which applications were taken up to the final quarter of FY26.

Fuel Relief

RV provided temporary business support subsidies in April and May 2026 to offset fuel cost pressures caused by the Middle East conflict. More than $900,000 in fuel relief was delivered to participants and raceday officials, complementing over $1 million in emergency drought and bushfire assistance provided across FY25 and FY26.

Health & Safety

RV is committed to promoting safe and healthy workplaces, facilities and operations across the VTRI and to supporting the physical and psychological wellbeing of participants and employees. During FY26, RV worked collaboratively with participants, Clubs, CRV, the ATA, employee representatives and WorkSafe Victoria to support ongoing improvements in health and safety across the VTRI.

Environment, Social and Governance Initiatives

Building a sustainable future for the VTRI remains a priority and is an important consideration in major strategic and operational decision making. Preparations for climate-related sustainability reporting are underway ahead of mandatory reporting requirements, and RV continues to review its Environment, Social and Governance (ESG) risks and opportunities. Current focus areas include:

Environment

- Managing capital projects with consideration for environmental impacts.
- Supporting sustainable infrastructure and operational decision-making.
- Encouraging efficient and responsible use of water and energy.
- Strengthening climate-related governance and reporting capability.
- Improving the industry's resilience to climate related risks, including heat, fire, flood and severe weather.

Social

- Promoting world-leading equine welfare outcomes.
- Protecting the health, safety and wellbeing of participants, staff and officials.
- Creating opportunities for rewarding careers.
- Advocating for diversity, equity, inclusion and respectful workplaces.
- Supporting regional communities through investment in the VTRI.
- Strengthening the VTRI's positive contribution to the broader community.

Governance

- Maintaining effective risk management and control frameworks.
- Fostering a culture of integrity, accountability, transparency and ethical decision-making.
- Monitoring emerging and relevant regulatory and public policy developments.
- Strengthening oversight of privacy, cybersecurity and data governance risks.
- Enhancing modern slavery and responsible procurement practices within supply chains.

Charitable Contributions

In addition to providing financial and social support to the VTRI, RV again made worthy contributions to a number of charities and community groups throughout FY26.

Following January 2026 bushfires that heavily impacted thoroughbred participants around Longwood, a major fundraiser at a Seymour raceday generated over $200,000 for the CFA & Brigades Donation Fund and Strathbogie Disaster Relief Fund. These funds, which supported first responders and the local rebuild, were on top of $175,000 in emergency aid provided by RV to bushfire affected participants.

Seymour was the first of four Racing For Our Regions

4 PARAGRAPHS WILL NOT FIT THIS SPREAD — TRIM THE COPY OR EXTEND